

Snake in Code

about 25 minutes, after the Code demo

You've asked for a snake game three times today, in Chat, in Cowork and in Design, with one vague sentence each time and the machine making every decision. This is the one where you stop being vague.

1. A FOLDER, MADE BY CLAUDE

In the desktop app, click the angle-bracket button at the top of the sidebar, the same Code screen you used for /context in the first lab. Start a new session and choose your Desktop as its folder. Type:

```
make me a directory named snake-code
```

Then start a new session and choose snake-code as its folder. That folder is what Claude can see from now on.

2. YOUR REQUIREMENTS

This time you make the decisions. Your game has to have:

- One HTML file. No framework, nothing to install.
- Canvas rendering.
- Arrow keys and WASD both work.
- A 20 by 20 grid.
- A score you can see.
- The snake can't reverse straight into itself.

Add one requirement of your own. Something you noticed you wanted while you played the other three.

3. PLAN FIRST

Claude Code has modes that set how much it does without asking you. In Plan mode it reads, thinks and proposes, and it doesn't write a single file until you approve the plan. That's the mode for this step.

To get into it: at the bottom of the Code screen, next to the send button, is the mode control. It shows the mode you're in now (a new session usually says Auto). Click it and choose Plan. If you can't find it, type /plan in the prompt line and press return; that does the same thing.

Now ask for the game, with your seven requirements in your own words. Don't paste the list: turning what you want into a prompt is the skill you're here for.

Claude comes back with a plan, and no file has been written. Read it. If it's missing a requirement, or it has decided something you'd rather decide, say so and let it revise the plan. When the plan is right, approve it and let it build.

4. CHECK IT AGAINST YOUR LIST

Open the game and test every requirement, one at a time. Try to reverse the snake into itself. If anything fails, tell Claude what you saw and let it fix it. Describe the symptom; don't guess the cause.

5. TWO REVISIONS

Change the game at least twice. For each change: back into Plan mode (the mode control, or /plan), ask for it, read the plan, approve it, test it. If you need ideas: a pause key, a high score that survives a refresh, a game that speeds up as the snake grows, walls you can turn off.

YOU'RE DONE WHEN

- snake-code holds a game that meets all seven requirements.
- You've made at least two changes, and you read a plan before each one.